

“Campus safety: A Weapon Free Zone” Academy

Middle/High School

A Weapon Free Zone Lesson Plan

Objectives:

- Students will learn about the laws surrounding the presence of weapons on campus
- Students will learn how to take an active role in preventing school violence

Materials:

- ✓ Poster paper and markers for each group
- ✓ ‘What would you do?’ Scenario Slips

Timeframe: 50 minutes

Activity:

1. Begin by dividing participants into groups of 4-5 students each.
2. Inform students that they will create a poster of their own “made-up” school with the following pretend information illustrated, labeled and listed:
 - Name of school
 - Illustration of Mascot
 - Location of school, i.e., city state, neighborhood, etc.
 - Grade levels in school
 - 5 rules to keep your school safe (ex. Weapon Free Zone, Anti-Bully, Cyber Safety, etc.)
3. As a group volunteer shares their group’s posters have them circle similarities with other groups.
4. Draw a T-Chart on the whiteboard and label it ‘Less’ and ‘More’. Discuss with students what would make their school more or less safe. Record their answers on the facilitator T-Chart.
5. After all groups have presented, circle answers on the T-chart related to weapons on campus. Inform students that Arizona Law prohibits individuals from bringing deadly weapons (including firearms) on campus.

ARS 13-3102A 12... Misconduct involving weapons; defenses; classification; definitions

A. A person commits misconduct involving weapons by knowingly:

12. Possessing a deadly weapon on school grounds; (Class 1 misdemeanor)

6. Explain that a deadly weapon does not have to be a handgun but it can be “anything designed for lethal use” (certain knives, bow and arrow, explosives, etc.) Also, mention that your school Code of Conduct has a more restrictive policy regarding weapons on campus. **Obtain a copy of your school’s code of conduct to share with the students at this time.
7. Inform the students that they play an important role in keeping their school a weapon free zone and preventing violence. Provide each group with the ‘What Would You Do?’ handout. Instruct groups to discuss the scene and create a role play on how they would appropriately handle the situation.
8. When each group is finished presenting their scenario provide appropriate feedback and comments.

9. Debrief the lesson by asking the following:
 - a. What are some reasons for laws about guns on campus
 - b. What are some ways you can help prevent violence on campus

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What would you do?

Scenario Slips

1. While passing in the hall, you notice a small group of students gathered around a locker. One student is showing a pocket knife with different gadgets to his friends.
2. You just got a cool air gun and you want to bring it to school to show your friends.
3. Your close friend has been a victim of cyberbullying and tells you they are going to “take care” of the person at school tomorrow. You know his father has guns in their home.
4. You receive a text from a friend telling you to leave the school because something bad is about to happen.
5. While you are standing by your locker you see what you believe to be gun in the boy’s locker beside you.

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Correlations

Arizona State Standards

Civics and Government	Health	Visual Art	Physical Education
Explain the obligations and responsibilities of citizenship: obeying the law (7-8 S3C4 PO4b)	Determine when health related situations require the application of a thoughtful decision-making process. (6-8 S5C2 PO1) Analyze the outcomes of a health-related decision. (6-8 S5C2 PO6)	Explain purposeful use of subject matter, symbols, and/or themes in his or her own artwork. (S1C4PO 201) Create artwork that communicate substantive meanings or achieve intended purposes (e.g., cultural, political, personal, spiritual, and commercial). S1C4PO 302	Employ appropriate conflict resolution strategies at times of interpersonal conflicts. (6-12 S5C2 PO3)

Arizona College and Career Ready Standards

Comprehension and Collaboration	Key Ideas and Details
<i>Engage, initiate, and participate</i> effectively in a range of collaborative discussions (one-on-one, in groups, and teacher-led) with diverse partners on grade <i>appropriate</i> topics, texts, and issues, building on others’ ideas and expressing their own clearly. (6-12 SL.1.)	Read closely to determine what the text says explicitly and to make logical inferences from it; cite specific textual evidence when writing or speaking to support conclusions drawn from the text. (6-12.RH.1) Determine the central ideas or information of a primary or secondary source; provide an accurate summary of the source. (6-12. RH.2)